

must also mention that for arcade games, you should probably 'Redefine Keys', which allows you to set which keys you'll press to move your character in the game—Q, Z, I, P used to work for me; maybe they will for you as well.

Before recommending a couple of titles to get you off the ground, let me warn you that the graphics are primitive. For instance, in some adventure games like the ones I talk about below, you'll have to wait while paint actually fills shapes in, and even the keyboard will probably feel a little sluggish. But if you are ready to use a bit of imagination, you'll find yourself having tremendous amounts of fun, and recommending the site to all your friends. It might even lead you to explore the retro scene in totality. The first game I suggest is 'The Hobbit', a textual adventure that came out in 1982, and as the name suggests, is based on the book. I won't give you any clues to spoil it—just play (let me just say that it is possible to complete the game with more than one possible ending). The second is 'The Never Ending Story 128', again, another textual adventure, but this is one with reasonable graphics (for the time it came out, at least). This is also based on the movie of the same name. And without giving anything away, you'll need to see the movie, otherwise there are parts of the game you won't be able to get past. If you're wondering where to get the movie, well, I have no idea.

Finally, since we're in no mood to spend our time typing, try the shooting game Exolon – fantastic graphics for the time (which hold up even today), a tune which sticks in your head, and awesome gameplay, the likes of which are lost on modern machines. There is another, very specific reason I want you to play Exolon, but maybe more of that in the future.

Okay, now that we've covered the Spectrum, let's talk about the other ways to play games on Linux, working our way up from the games of the past, to the latest greatest. DOS games, which you played from the command line back when that OS was prevalent, have been archived on quite a few sites on the Net, one of which is www.abandonia.com. You'll need an emulator which provides a DOS environment to the games, and it so happens that one of them, QEMU, ships with Fedora 20! Wasn't that nice of them, to make our lives as easy as that! The emulator simulates a DOS environment, that is, makes the program think that it has the whole machine to itself. This was needed back then, as the machines were relatively slow, and the band of game programmers wanted to write as efficient code as possible to make their games run smoothly.

The games I love best among these are the graphical adventures, as you may have guessed from my text about 'The Hobbit'. So let me recommend a couple – 'Conquests of the Longbow' and 'The Adventures of Willy Beamish', which despite its graphics, is quite a 'grown-ups' game. In case you're not familiar with DOS commands, after you've unzipped the file you downloaded and started the emulator, you'll probably need to mount your hard drive, or a directory

on it, as a drive letter to the emulated DOS. This is similar to how you mount a partition on Linux – very simple! After this, just 'cd' to the required directory, and type the name of the '.EXE' file, and the game should start. Explore Abandonia – there are many, many, great pieces of software to be experienced, and if you can, please send them a bit of cash; it'll help keep people like you entertained.

Right, now let's get to the *third* way you can play games on Linux. Windows is the most prevalent gaming OS that everyone uses. The two ways you can do this are: 1) Play Windows games on Linux with an emulator such as Wine, or 2) Play Linux native games by downloading them from an app store (more on that later). Windows games can use either of the two 3D APIs that ship with the system: OpenGL or DirectX. However, in practice, just about every awesome, modern game that you can think of will use DirectX, and will probably be using the GPU (Graphics Processing Unit) on your 3D card, if you have one. This is in direct contrast to Linux, which supports only OpenGL (which uses your 3D card too), because, as can be expected, DirectX is proprietary to Microsoft. Thankfully, someone spotted a market and decided to do something about it, which is why we have something called CrossOver, a front-end for Wine which will allow you to play Windows games on Linux. Unfortunately, it's not free, which means that most of you won't get to use it, and the wonderful work that the folks at Codeweavers put in will go to waste. This brings us to the last option – Linux native games.

Now, as those of you who tried out TuxRacer from the OSFY DVD that came with the September 2014 issue will know, Linux native games *do* exist, and the situation has been greatly improved by the team from Valve Software (the creators of 'Half-Life') releasing Steam for Linux some time back. This, hopefully, is the tip of the iceberg, and we'll soon be seeing many more releases for Linux, including a super awesome Linux game that's *exclusive* to Linux, i.e., it will NOT have a Windows version. It's to prepare you for that day that I'm writing this, so start downloading. Incidentally, the website [Gog.com](http://www.gog.com) has also launched a section for Linux games, available at http://www.gog.com/news/gogcom_now_supports_linux; so check that out.

The games actually available on Steam are pretty much the regular crop – scrollers, car racers and the like, and of course, the ubiquitous first-person shooters. Talking of first-person shooters, a word needs to be said about John Carmack. He's the father of modern 3D game technology, as has been said and reported in various places, and the creator of, first, 'Wolfenstein 3D', then 'Doom', 'Quake', and so on. All of these, 'Doom' onwards, have had Linux versions. In fact, his company, id Software, took a stance on this early on. John also single-handedly created the market for 3D graphics cards, because everyone wanted to know what the latest games looked like when being played on a computer that had this card. However, in all his games, you're supposed to look